

Gladius · \$GLAD

Dignitas Scoring Methodology

Technical Note — Draft IV

Catena vinciens libertatem, aequalitatem, humanitatem

“The chain that binds liberty, equality, and humanity”

I DE DIGNITATE

Purpose and Principles

Dignitas is the ethical reputation score assigned to every entity — company, organization, or individual — seeking or holding Civitas status within the Gladius community. It is not a single number but a structured profile of scores across five categories, each derived from the criteria of the Lex Gladii and grounded in the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

The Dignitas methodology is designed around four principles: transparency (every score is accompanied by auditable reasoning); consistency (AI-powered assessment applies identical standards to every entity); fairness (data gaps are treated as neutral, not penalizing); and contextual honesty (scores are interpreted in light of the UDHR signature status of the entity’s country of origin and its relative power in the market).

Dignitas is not a judgment of character. It is a structured, evidence-based assessment of observable conduct against a universal and publicly agreed standard.

II DE FUNDAMENTO

Primary Criterion — UDHR Signature Status

Before any category score is calculated, the UDHR signature status of the entity’s country of origin is established. This serves as the primary contextual frame for the entire Dignitas profile. It does not replace category scores but provides essential context for interpreting them.

Status	Definition	Effect on Profile
Signatory	Country has ratified the UDHR and relevant binding conventions	Scores interpreted at face value. Full Civitas eligibility.
Partial signatory	Country has signed UDHR but not all binding conventions	Scores noted with partial context flag. Civitas eligibility subject to Council review for affected categories.
Non-signatory	Country has not signed the UDHR or has formally withdrawn	Scores carry non-signatory flag. Entity must demonstrate exceptional voluntary compliance to achieve Civitas.

UDHR signature data is drawn from the United Nations Treaty Collection, updated annually and verified by the AI assessment layer. The Council may rule on edge cases where a country’s de facto human rights record diverges significantly from its formal treaty status.

III DE POTESTATE

The Potestas Index — Power and Scrutiny

The scale of an entity’s influence determines the scale of its potential impact on society. A business decision taken by an entity with significant market reach carries wider consequences than the same decision taken by a smaller organization. The Potestas index reflects this proportionality within the Dignitas framework, ensuring that scrutiny is commensurate with influence.

Potestas is not a punishment for success. It is an acknowledgment that power and accountability are inseparable. Smaller entities — whose ethical conduct has less systemic impact — benefit from Standard tier access, reflecting that acting ethically without the resources of a large corporation is itself admirable.

Level	Threshold	Scrutiny	Maximum Civitas Benefit
Standard	Default — SMEs, startups, NGOs, individuals	1.0×	Full ecosystem access. Enhanced benefits above 85 overall.
Elevated	Dominant market position in primary sector	1.25×	Full ecosystem access.
High	Monopoly or near-monopoly in primary sector	1.5×	Partial ecosystem access. Preferential DeFi pool access restricted.
Critical	Cross-sector systemic influence — dominant in two or more critical sectors, or controlling critical public infrastructure or personal data of more than 500 million people globally	2.0×	Signal recognition only. No preferential financial benefits. Civitas serves as reputational marker only.

The scrutiny multiplier means that achieving a given Dignitas score requires proportionally more positive evidence as Potestas level increases. A Critical tier entity must demonstrate twice the depth of compliance to achieve the same score as a Standard tier entity. Potestas classification is determined annually by the Council, drawing on competition authority data, market share analyses, and infrastructure assessments.

Structural power is itself a handicap within Gladius. This is not a penalty — it is a mirror held up to reality.

IV DE CATEGORIIS

The Five Score Categories

Each entity receives a score from 0 to 100 in each of the five categories below. All categories carry equal weight. No single category can be traded off against another — a very high Environment score does not compensate for a very low Rights score. Each category score is published independently and in full.

Democracy UDHR Articles: 19, 21, 26, 27

Assesses respect for freedom of expression, support for democratic institutions and electoral processes, commitment to independent education and research (including the universitas — universities and research institutions free from political or commercial capture), and support for independent culture and art.

Labor UDHR Articles: 20, 23

Assesses freedom of association and collective organization, fair wages, safe working conditions, and the absence of forced or child labor throughout the entity's operations and Tier 1 supply chain.

Environment UDHR Articles: 25

Assesses commitment to clean and renewable energy, reduction of harmful emissions, responsible use of shared natural resources, and the entity's broader environmental impact on the commons.

Rights UDHR Articles: 12, 17, 29, 18

Assesses respect for privacy and personal data, property rights and financial integrity, non-discrimination, tolerance of the rights of others, and — for religiously or ideologically affiliated entities — demonstrable charitable benefit to the

broader community.

Finance UDHR Articles: 17

Assesses transparency of financial practices, absence of predatory, fraudulent, or exploitative financial behavior, and compliance with applicable financial regulations in the entity's country of operation.

ISO 26000 Alignment — Amendment IV.1

Each Dignitas category, while constitutionally grounded in the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, aligns with the core subjects of ISO 26000:2010 — the principal international guidance standard for social responsibility. This alignment is provided for interoperability: entities, partners, and assessors familiar with ISO 26000 can locate each Dignitas category within that framework, and documentation prepared for ISO 26000-based processes (including EcoVadis assessments and Lucie 26000 certification) can serve directly as voluntary disclosure evidence under Dignitas.

Dignitas Category	UDHR Articles	ISO 26000 Core Subjects
Democracy	19, 21, 26, 27	6.2 Organizational governance · 6.6 Fair operating practices (responsible political involvement) · 6.8 Community involvement and development (education and culture)
Labor	20, 23	6.4 Labour practices · 6.3 Human rights (fundamental principles and rights at work)
Environment	25	6.5 The environment
Rights	12, 17, 29, 18	6.3 Human rights (due diligence, discrimination, civil and political rights) · 6.7 Consumer issues (data protection and privacy)
Finance	17	6.6 Fair operating practices (anti-corruption, fair competition) · 6.7 Consumer issues (fair marketing, protecting consumers)

ISO 26000 is a guidance standard and is not certifiable; no entity gains or loses Dignitas points by reference to ISO 26000 itself. The mapping is interpretive.

V DE INDICIBUS

The Indicator Rubric

Within each category, the AI assessment layer monitors specific, observable indicators drawn from public sources. Each indicator is assigned a severity level if violated. The following rubric defines the indicators, their sources, and their severity.

Signal Severity Scale

Level	Definition	Score Impact	Automatic Action
Informational	Minor gap, unverified claim, or matter pending resolution	−5 points	None
Medium	Verified gap or minor violation; remediation underway	−15 points	None
High	Confirmed violation with no remediation evident	−30 points	Council notified

Critical	Serious or systematic violation — forced labor, criminal conviction, deliberate suppression of democratic institutions	–50 points. Floor score of 25 applies.	Monito within 7 days
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Pattern rule: Three or more High severity signals within any 12-month period are treated as systematic misconduct and escalated to Critical tier, regardless of whether any single signal qualifies as Critical individually.

Floor score rule: A confirmed Critical violation creates a floor score of 25/100 in the affected category. This floor cannot be overridden by voluntary disclosure bonuses. It lifts only after full remediation verified by the Council, with a minimum waiting period of 12 months.

Democracy Indicators — Art. 19, 21, 26, 27

Indicator	Source	Severity if Violated
No suppression of employee or public expression	Court records, investigative journalism, NGO reports	Critical
No active funding or support of anti-democratic movements	Financial disclosures, investigative journalism	Critical
Support for or partnership with independent universities	Company disclosures, university partnership records	Medium
No commercial or political capture of research outputs	Academic integrity reports, investigative journalism	High
Support for independent cultural and artistic production	Company disclosures, arts funding records	Medium
No instrumentalization of culture for political ends	Civil society reports, investigative journalism	High

Labor Indicators — Art. 20, 23

ILO references correspond to the ILO fundamental conventions where applicable. A documented violation established by ILO supervisory bodies, national labor inspectorates, or courts constitutes a confirmed signal at the stated severity. C100 and C111 (equal remuneration and non-discrimination) are covered under Rights category indicators.

Indicator	Source	ILO Convention	Severity if Violated
Union recognition formally in place	Company filings, labor ministry records	C87	High
No history of union-busting activity	Court records, NGO reports, investigative journalism	C87 · C98	Critical
Collective bargaining agreements in place	Company disclosures, union records	C98	Medium
No retaliation against workers organizing	Labor tribunal records, NGO reports	C98	Critical
Living wage certification or equivalent	Certified living wage bodies, company disclosures	C131	High
CEO-to-median-worker pay ratio published	Company annual reports, regulatory filings	—	Medium

No forced or child labor in operations	ILO reports, labor inspection records, NGO reports	C29 · C105 · C138 · C182	Critical
No forced or child labor in Tier 1 supply chain	Supply chain audits, NGO reports	C29 · C105 · C138 · C182	Critical
Safe working conditions — no serious violations	Labor inspection records, court records	C155 · C187	High

Environment Indicators — Art. 25

Indicator	Source	Severity if Violated
100% renewable energy usage or credible transition plan	Energy certifications, company disclosures	High
No active investment in fossil fuel extraction	Financial disclosures, regulatory filings	High
Net-zero roadmap published with measurable milestones	Company disclosures, ESG reports	Medium
No record of significant environmental violations	Environmental agency records, court records	Critical
Carbon emissions publicly disclosed	Company disclosures, ESG reports	Medium
No active lobbying against climate regulation	Lobbying registers, investigative journalism	High

Rights Indicators — Art. 12, 17, 29, 18

Indicator	Source	Severity if Violated
GDPR or equivalent data protection compliance	Regulatory records, data protection authority decisions	High
No unlawful surveillance of employees or users	Court records, investigative journalism, NGO reports	Critical
No predatory or fraudulent financial practices	Financial regulatory records, court records	Critical
No active support for intolerant or rights-suppressing movements	Financial disclosures, investigative journalism	Critical
For religiously/ideologically affiliated entities: demonstrable charitable benefit to the broader community	Charity commission records, civil society reports	High
Non-discrimination policy in place and enforced	Company disclosures, tribunal records	High

Finance Indicators — Art. 17

Indicator	Source	Severity if Violated
Full financial disclosure published annually	Company annual reports, regulatory filings	Medium
Clean regulatory record — no significant financial violations	Financial regulatory authority records, court records	High
No predatory lending, price gouging, or exploitative practices	Regulatory records, consumer protection authority decisions	Critical

No involvement in tax evasion or aggressive tax avoidance	Tax authority records, investigative journalism	High
No financing of entities failing Lex Gladii criteria	Financial disclosures, investigative journalism	High

VI DE DIVULGATIONE

Voluntary Disclosure Bonus

Entities that proactively publish data beyond minimum legal requirements receive a transparency bonus, reflecting that voluntary accountability is itself an ethical signal. No expensive third-party certifications are required — the bonus rewards honest, public disclosure of information that allows the community to assess compliance independently.

Disclosure	Category Bonus
CEO-to-median-worker pay ratio published voluntarily	Labor +3 points
Full supply chain published voluntarily	Labor +4 points
Carbon emissions and energy consumption published voluntarily	Environment +3 points
Internal data protection audit published voluntarily	Rights +3 points
Lobbying activities and expenditure published voluntarily	Democracy / Finance +3 points each
Maximum bonus per category	+10 points

De Certificationibus Externis — Third-Party Certification Recognition (Amendment IV.3)

Entities holding current, verifiable certifications from established external frameworks receive recognition bonuses in the relevant categories. This reflects two facts: first, that undergoing independent external assessment is itself an act of voluntary accountability; second, that the evidence trail generated by these certifications materially improves the data available to the assessment layer.

Three principles govern this recognition:

- 1. Recognition, never requirement.** No third-party certification is required for any Dignitas score or Civitas status. The absence of certification is never penalized. Dignitas remains accessible to entities that cannot afford legacy certification processes.
- 2. Currency and verifiability.** A certification qualifies only while current and verifiable in the certifier’s public registry. A lapsed, suspended, or revoked certification removes the bonus at the next recalculation. Revocation for cause is itself recorded as a Medium severity signal in the affected category.
- 3. Subordination to observed conduct.** A certification bonus is suspended immediately when a High or Critical severity signal is confirmed in the same category. A certificate cannot shield observed misconduct — conduct outranks credentials. Certification bonuses cannot override the floor score of 25 following a Critical violation.

Certification	Requirement	Category Bonus	Verification Source
B Corp (B Lab)	Current certification in good standing	+2 in each of the five categories	B Lab public directory

SA8000 (Social Accountability International)	Current certificate from SAAS-accredited body	Labor +5	SAAS certified facilities list
EcoVadis Gold or Platinum	Current medal, scorecard shared publicly or with Gladius	Environment +3 · Labor +3	EcoVadis scorecard
UN Global Compact	Active participant with current Communication on Progress filed	+1 in each of the five categories	UN Global Compact participant database

The maximum total bonus per category — voluntary disclosures and certification recognition combined — remains **+10 points**. Where an entity qualifies for bonuses exceeding the cap, the cap applies.

Certifications not listed may be proposed for recognition through the Comitia governance process. The Council reviews the recognition table annually and may suspend recognition of any framework whose own integrity is credibly compromised.

A certificate is testimony, not proof. Dignitas hears the testimony — and keeps watching.

VII DE TEMPORE

Sanction Timelines

A scoring system without clear trigger timelines is without force. The following timelines govern how quickly the disciplinary process activates in response to identified violations. Speed of response reflects the seriousness of the community’s commitment to the Lex Gladii.

Trigger	Action	Timeline
Critical severity signal detected	Monitio issued automatically	Within 7 days
Score drops below 55 in any category	Council notified	Within 48 hours
Score drops below 40 in any category	Monitio issued automatically	Within 30 days
High severity signal unresolved after 30 days	Monitio issued	Day 30
Monitio unresolved — score remains below 40	Suspensio enacted	Within 60 days of Monitio
Second Critical signal within 24 months	Immediate Suspensio; Expulsio proceedings begin	Immediate
Three or more High signals within 12 months	Escalated to Critical tier; Monitio issued	Within 7 days of third signal

VIII DE LACUNIS

Handling Data Gaps and Supply Chains

Data Gaps

Where public data is unavailable for a given criterion — typically in jurisdictions with limited disclosure requirements or restricted press freedom — the relevant signal is recorded as neutral and contributes a score of 50/100 to the relevant category. This reflects genuine uncertainty rather than assumed compliance or violation. Entities may voluntarily submit additional evidence to supplement public data, creating a positive incentive for transparency.

Supply Chain Responsibility

Tier 1 suppliers — those in direct contractual relationship with the entity — are fully within scope of the Dignitas assessment. Responsibility for Tier 2 and beyond is triggered only by proven knowledge of violations, defined as:

- Credible public reporting that the entity has been directly and formally informed of the violation.
- Internal communications demonstrating awareness, where these have become public through legal proceedings or whistleblowing.
- Industry-wide knowledge — where violations in a specific supply tier are so extensively documented that ignorance is not credible for any reasonably informed operator in that sector.

A neutral score is an honest score. It says: we do not have enough information to judge. It does not say: we assume the worst.

IX DE INTERPRETATIONE

Score Interpretation

Each Dignitas profile consists of five category scores (0–100) and an overall average, presented alongside the entity’s UDHR signature status and Potestas level. The following bands provide a reference for interpretation:

Band	Score	Interpretation	Civitas Implication
Exemplary	85–100	Strong positive signals across all monitored criteria	Full Civitas. Standard tier entities eligible for enhanced benefits.
Good standing	70–84	Consistent compliance with minor gaps or uncertainties	Full Civitas.
Adequate	55–69	Generally compliant but with notable gaps or unresolved signals	Civitas granted with monitoring flag. Council notified.
Marginal	40–54	Significant data gaps or mixed signals requiring attention	Civitas under review. Monitio may be issued.
Failing	0–39	Credible evidence of UDHR violations in this category	Civitas suspended in affected category. Disciplinary process initiated.

A score of 0–39 in any single category triggers the disciplinary process regardless of scores in other categories. There is no averaging across categories that can mask a serious failure in one area.

X DE APPELLATIONE

Review, Appeals, and Updates

Any entity that disputes its Dignitas score may petition the Council for review. A petition must include specific counter-evidence addressing the signals cited in the audit trail. The Council reviews petitions within 30 days and may instruct the AI assessment layer to recalculate on the basis of new evidence.

Dignitas scores are recalculated continuously as new data becomes available, with a full profile refresh published at minimum every quarter. A movement of more than 10 points in any category triggers an automatic notification to the entity and to the Council. The methodology itself is reviewed annually by the Council and may be amended through the Comitia governance process. All methodology versions are archived on-chain and publicly accessible.

A score that cannot be challenged is not a score — it is a verdict. The appeals process is not a weakness of the system. It is its integrity.